

Sexuality

Sexuality is more than just having sex. It is the complex interaction of a person's desires, preferences, experiences, and beliefs throughout their life.

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What is sexuality?

Because everyone's innate self and experience of being in the world are different, everyone's sexuality is different. Exploring sexuality can mean thinking about things that aren't obviously about sex, like the rules in society and culture that influence how people behave. Sexuality is a marker of a person's identity, just like their gender, hair, eye or skin color, culture, or religion.

Understanding sexuality

As much as people might want to, it can be hard to tell what factors affect their sexuality or why they feel a certain way. Some people don't question or even think about their sexuality, while others find that their understanding and relationship with their sexuality evolves over time. It can be confusing, particularly for teens who become increasingly aware of their sexuality during adolescence, but exploring sexuality and the ideas connected to it can help teens to better understand this important aspect of themselves.



▷ Influences

The factors affecting sexuality overlap and interlink. There are far more factors than this image shows.